

Michael Noetel

ASSOCIATE PROFESSOR · THE UNIVERSITY OF QUEENSLAND

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Summary

I work to reduce catastrophic risks from advanced AI while helping others do the most good they can. My work integrates consensus-building, evidence synthesis, and scalable public communication to deliver policy-ready guidance at the pace of frontier AI.

Select AI Governance Contributions

- **SARA Project:** Led the Survey of Assessing Risks from AI, which informed Australia's Safe and Responsible AI in Australia discussion paper.
- **AI Risk Repository:** Co-authored repository of AI risk pathways (airisk.mit.edu), cited in the International AI Safety Report (2024).
- **Field-building:** Facilitated three cohorts of the AGI Safety Fundamentals Governance Course (BlueDot Impact) and supervise graduate research on frontier evals, AI literacy, AI consciousness, and public risk perception.

Teaching & Engagement Impact

- **Award-winning educator:** 9 national & institutional awards, incl. Australian Award for University Teaching & Vice-Chancellor's Award for Excellence. Mean student rating 4.8/5 across 2,390 students.
- **Public science communicator:** 10 *Conversation* articles (250K+ reads); media interviews for CNN, BBC, ABC, PBS NewsHour, The Times, including TV and live radio; invited to brief federal parliamentarians.
- **Chair,** Effective Altruism Australia since 2021 – stewarding AU\$7.5M+/yr to cost-effective global-health and climate change programs.

Research Excellence

- **High-impact evidence synthesis:** Lead author, network meta-analysis of exercise for depression (*BMJ*, Altmetric > 1,400; 100M+ media reach). Publications in my fields' top journals: *Nature Human Behaviour*, *Psychological Bulletin*, *Review of Educational Research*.
- **Competitive funding:** Chief Investigator on AU\$3.7M Category 1 grants (NHMRC, MRFF, ARC).
- **Transparent & truth-seeking:** Embed pre-registration, open data/code; lead multi-institution teams using Agile & Scrum.
- **Metrics of excellence** (Web of Science): h-index **24** m-index **3.5** (>2 = 'outstanding scientist'); **39.2%** of papers in top-10% most-cited; mean CNCI **3.96** (1.0 = world average).

Skills

Evidence synthesis

Systematic reviews, Meta-analyses, Expert elicitation (e.g., Delphi)

Leadership

Agile project leadership, Stakeholder engagement, Board governance

Communication

Video production, Media engagement, Policy briefs, Knowledge translation

Technical

R, Agentic AI, Git, OSF, Data analysis, Reproducible workflows

Education

Doctor of Philosophy

INSTITUTE FOR POSITIVE PSYCHOLOGY AND EDUCATION

Australian Catholic University

2019

Masters of Applied Psychology

The University of Queensland

2010

Bachelor of Science (Advanced, Honours)

DOUBLE MAJOR: PSYCHOLOGY; COMPUTATIONAL SCIENCE

University of Sydney

2008

Academic Experience

Associate Professor

SCHOOL OF PSYCHOLOGY

The University of Queensland

2025–Present

Affiliate Researcher

FUTURETECH

Massachusetts Institute of Technology

2025–Present

Senior Lecturer

SCHOOL OF PSYCHOLOGY

The University of Queensland

2022–2024

Senior Lecturer

SCHOOL OF HEALTH AND BEHAVIOURAL SCIENCES

Australian Catholic University

2020–2022

Research Fellow (Secondment; .4 FTE)

INSTITUTE FOR POSITIVE PSYCHOLOGY AND EDUCATION

Australian Catholic University

2018–2019

Lecturer

SCHOOL OF HEALTH AND BEHAVIOURAL SCIENCES

Australian Catholic University

2015–2019

Accreditations

SFHEA (2020); Registered Psychologist, AHPRA (2012); Board Approved Supervisor (2015)

Awards

Vice-Chancellor's Award for Excellence in Teaching

Australian Catholic University

2021

Vice-Chancellor's Staff Excellence Award: Research & Research Partnership

Australian Catholic University – iPLAY Team

2021

Excellence and Innovation in Public Health Education and Research (Team)

CAPHIA – iPLAY Team

2021

Citation for Outstanding Contributions to Student Learning

Australian Awards for University Teaching

2020

Citations for Outstanding Contributions to Student Learning

Australian Catholic University

2019

Select Publications

[Vasconcellos, et al. \(2025\). Electronic Screen Use and Children's Socioemotional Problems: A Systematic Review and Meta-Analysis of Longitudinal Studies](#)

Psychological Bulletin — 16 citations | CNCI: 19

[Wallace, et al. \(2025\). Expert-derived recommendations for designing and facilitating tabletop crisis exercises: A Delphi study](#)
Safety Science

[Swaryandini, et al. \(2025\). Systematic review and meta-analysis of educational approaches to reduce cognitive biases among students](#)

Nature Human Behaviour

[Noetel, et al. \(2024\). Effect of exercise for depression: systematic review and network meta-analysis of randomised controlled trials](#)
bmj — 353 citations | CNCI: 41.53

[Sanders, et al. \(2024\). An umbrella review of the benefits and risks associated with youths' interactions with electronic screens](#)
Nature Human Behaviour — 92 citations | CNCI: 3.79

[Guo, et al. \(2024\). Harnessing Artificial Intelligence in Generative Content for enhancing motivation in learning](#)
Learning and Individual Differences — 11 citations | CNCI: 4.06

[Ahmadi, et al. \(2023\). A Classification System for Teachers' Motivational Behaviors Recommended in Self-Determination Theory Interventions](#)

Journal of Educational Psychology — 311 citations | CNCI: 48.59

[Wilhite, et al. \(2023\). Combinations of Physical Activity, Sedentary Behavior, and Sleep Duration and Their Associations With Physical, Psychological, and Educational Outcomes in Children and Adolescents: A Systematic Review](#)

American Journal of Epidemiology — 125 citations | CNCI: 5.04

[Gallardo-Gomez, et al. \(2023\). Optimal dose and type of physical activity to improve functional capacity and minimise adverse events in acutely hospitalised older adults: a systematic review with dose-response network meta-analysis of randomised controlled trials](#)
British Journal of Sports Medicine — 32 citations | CNCI: 2.42

[Gallardo-Gomez, et al. \(2022\). Optimal dose and type of exercise to improve cognitive function in older adults: A systematic review and bayesian model-based network meta-analysis of RCTs](#)
Ageing Research Reviews — 186 citations | CNCI: 5.07

[Noetel, et al. \(2022\). Multimedia Design for Learning: An Overview of Reviews With Meta-Meta-Analysis](#)
Review of Educational Research — 86 citations | CNCI: 2.24

[Noetel, et al. \(2021\). Video Improves Learning in Higher Education: A Systematic Review](#)
Review of Educational Research — 193 citations | CNCI: 5.41

[Vella, et al. \(2021\). An Intervention for Mental Health Literacy and Resilience in Organized Sports](#)
Medicine & Science in Sports & Exercise — 86 citations | CNCI: 7.01

[Lubans, et al. \(2021\). Time-efficient intervention to improve older adolescents' cardiorespiratory fitness: findings from the 'Burn 2 Learn' cluster randomised controlled trial](#)
British Journal of Sports Medicine — 69 citations | CNCI: 5.59

[Hartwig, et al. \(2021\). School-based interventions modestly increase physical activity and cardiorespiratory fitness but are least effective for youth who need them most: an individual participant pooled analysis of 20 controlled trials](#)
British Journal of Sports Medicine — 56 citations | CNCI: 2.15

[Donald, et al. \(2021\). Paths to the Light and Dark Sides of Human Nature: A Meta-Analytic Review of the Prosocial Benefits of Autonomy and the Antisocial Costs of Control](#)
Psychological Bulletin — 43 citations | CNCI: 1.22

[Lonsdale, et al. \(2021\). Effect of a Scalable School-Based Intervention on Cardiorespiratory Fitness in Children A Cluster Randomized Clinical Trial](#)
Jama Pediatrics — 25 citations | CNCI: 2.63

[Parker, et al. \(2020\). The Intersection of Gender, Social Class, and Cultural Context: a Meta-Analysis](#)
Educational Psychology Review — 51 citations | CNCI: 3.09

[Valkenborghs, et al. \(2019\). The Impact of Physical Activity on Brain Structure and Function in Youth: A Systematic Review](#)
Pediatrics — 145 citations | CNCI: 5.47

[Noetel, et al. \(2019\). Mindfulness and acceptance approaches to sporting performance enhancement: a systematic review](#)
International Review of Sport and Exercise Psychology — 122 citations

[Sanders, et al. \(2019\). Type of screen time moderates effects on outcomes in 4013 children: evidence from the Longitudinal Study of Australian Children](#)
International Journal of Behavioral Nutrition and Physical Activity — 115 citations | CNCI: 4.22

[Beetham, et al. \(2019\). The effects of vigorous intensity exercise in the third trimester of pregnancy: a systematic review and meta-analysis](#)
Bmc Pregnancy and Childbirth — 102 citations | CNCI: 2.63

[del Pozo-Cruz, et al. \(2019\). Joint physical-activity/screen-time trajectories during early childhood: socio-demographic predictors and consequences on health-related quality-of-life and socio-emotional outcomes](#)
International Journal of Behavioral Nutrition and Physical Activity — 54 citations | CNCI: 2.16

[Leahy, et al. \(2019\). Feasibility and Preliminary Efficacy of a Teacher-Facilitated High-Intensity Interval Training Intervention for Older Adolescents](#)
Pediatric Exercise Science — 50 citations | CNCI: 2.85

[Vella, et al. \(2018\). Ahead of the game protocol: a multi-component, community sport-based program targeting prevention, promotion and early intervention for mental health among adolescent males](#)
Bmc Public Health — 55 citations | CNCI: 2.38

Full publication list: orcid.org/0000-0002-2993-5686

Research Grants

AI Risk Index: Assessing influential organizations' responses to risks from AI	2025–2027
Subaward with MIT	\$663,766
Seeing the Bigger Picture: Exploring Children's Screen Time	2025–2026
NSW Dept of Education	\$341,307
Promotion of evidence-based physical activity for older adults and people with disabilities	2022–2025
NHMRC (PRC1: 2011157)	\$1,440,375
Prototyping a co-designed effective altruism program	2022–2023
Open Philanthropy	\$58,000

Effectiveness of school-based physical activity for adolescents with disability MRFF (2007095)	2021–2023 \$736,399
Meta-review of institutional decision-making EA Infrastructure Fund	2021–2022 \$39,654
Square eyes or all lies? Understanding children's exposure to screens ARC Discovery (DP200101912)	2020–2023 \$658,544
PLAY for Inclusion – Teachers working with children with intellectual disability Move It AUS	2019–2020 \$268,802
Engaging students during the early years of secondary school (iTEACH) ARC Discovery (DP160102625)	2016–2020 \$590,000

Media Coverage

Screen use and socio-emotional problems Altmetric: 122 news outlets, 21 Bluesky posts, cited in policy documents. ABC News 24, Good Morning America, Nine News, National Newscorp, RTBF, CNN	2025
Risks from advanced artificial intelligence The Courier-Mail, Ten News, SmartCompany, The Conversation, The Conversation	2024
Children and screens (umbrella review) Altmetric: 65 news outlets, 4 policy documents, 4 Wikipedia pages. Sydney Morning Herald, Le Monde, Le Figaro, El País, Daily Mail, Psychology Today, The Conversation	2024
Exercise for depression Altmetric: 111 news outlets, 1,546 X posts, 15 YouTube creators, 5 Wikipedia pages, 535 citations. CNN, Good Morning America, PBS NewsHour, The Times, NPR, ABC Radio, The Australian, National Geographic	2024
Effective altruism ABC Religion & Ethics, ABC Radio National, The Conversation	2021
Videos in higher education Forbes, The Conversation	2020

Invited Talks & Government Briefings

- **Government briefings:** Indonesian Ministry of Communication and Digital Affairs (2026); Ministry of Education, Republic of China – Taiwan (2025); Australian Depts of Industry, Science and Resources (2025), Education (2025), and Health, Disability and Ageing (2024).
- **Invited talks:** University of Pennsylvania, Master of Behavioral and Decision Sciences (2026); Universitas Indonesia (2025, 2026); EAGxAustralia keynotes/workshops (2019, 2022, 2023, 2025); Berkeley Effective Altruism (2022); HERDSA (2023); NASPSA, Hawaii (2022); Sports Medicine Australia (2020).

Research Supervision

PhD supervisor: 6 primary, 5 associate (2019–present). Honours: 43 students from 2023–2026.

Service & Engagement

Program Director (Academic), Master of Psychology	UQ School of Psychology 2023–2026
Director and Chairperson STEWARDSHIP AU\$7.5M+/YR TO COST-EFFECTIVE PROGRAMS	Effective Altruism Australia 2021–Present
Co-Lead, AI and Digital Psychology Stream SCIENTIFIC COMMITTEE	34th International Congress of Psychology 2026–2028
Editorial Board Member	Sport, Exercise and Performance Psychology (APA) 2025–Present